

Subject Matter and Project Achievement (Weight 40%)

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Class/grade	First (Excellent)			Upper second (Very Good)			Lower Second (Good)			Third (Sufficient)			Fail (insufficient)			Grade/ Comment
Assessment criteria	*Exceptional 1st			High 2.1	Mid 2.1	Low 2.1	High 2.2	Mid 2.2	Low 2.2	High 3 rd	Mid 3 rd	Low 3 rd	Mar' fail	Mid Fail	Low Fail	
	High 1st	Mid 1st	Low 1st													
Subject matter – type of work undertaken	Research, investigative, or trial of novel idea, representing a real intellectual challenge. Or commercial project with real customer & complex/unfamiliar requirements. Highly professional and confident demonstration showing deep understanding, originality, and full functionality. *Publishable Research			Relatively novel implementation or analysis of a pre-existing topic using an implementation as a test-bed. Or commercial project with real customer in close contact, hard deadlines and requirements. Strong demo with clear evidence of good implementation and understanding of technical aspects.			Mainstream, low risk implementation/trial with no external analysis Commercial customer in theory - but no hard requirements or deadlines. Functional demo showing the main aspects, though lacking originality or depth			Small-scale implementation or superficial investigation with minimal scope and ill-defined question. No "customer". Basic or incomplete demo; limited explanation of what is being shown.			Lack of understanding of the problem. No working demo or failure to demonstrate understanding of work undertaken.			
Project Size	A substantial piece of work. Requiring the construction of a significant solution to difficult problems. Using high level skills The work exceeds the expectations for a 40 credit level 6 coursework assignment. Demonstration clearly shows system complexity, multiple features, and technical depth. Demonstrate measurable technical performance and quantitative evaluation (e.g., benchmarks, throughput, scalability, accuracy) *Project requiring the acquisition and use of			The project represents a qualitative approach to the problems identified. The work is in line with the expectations for a 40 credit level 6 coursework assignment. Include some quantitative assessment of performance or functionality alongside qualitative evaluation Demonstration covers main functionality and conveys the project's scope effectively.			Problems solved are quantitative in nature. Report and solution is limited in scope and complexity. The work is below the expectations for a 40 credit level 6 coursework assignment. Limited quantitative testing provided; scope or complexity may not fully justify Level 6 expectations Demo shows limited functionality or small part of the overall system.			No significant problems solved or basic investigation undertaken The work is far below the expectations for a 40 credit level 6 coursework assignment. Minimal quantitative or technical data; limited evidence of measurable outcomes. Demo shows only basic working elements; lacks completeness.			A minimal solution or investigation. The work is insufficient for a 40 credit level 6 coursework assignment. No quantitative evaluation or measurable demonstration of project performance. No functioning demo or unclear presentation of project outcome.			

	expertise in more than one specialist area.					
Achievement	All main targets completed. Demonstration effectively communicates achievements, performance, and impact. *exceeded, or failures analysed and understood in a creative or surprising way.	Most initial targets met or project turned out harder than anticipated and actual progress good (with hindsight). Demo confirms solid achievement with clear explanation and confidence.	Development or investigation not completed. Some targets met. Student errors partly responsible. No failure analysis. Demo partially shows results but lacks clear evidence of success or testing.	Some functionality or trials carried out. One target met. Student errors responsible for failures. Minimal demo evidence; explanations weak or incomplete.	No functionality. Investigation random or minimal trial carried out. No targets met. No demo or cannot demonstrate any meaningful progress or understanding.	
Initiative (Supervisor only)	Student solved major project problems independently. Student presented project in a novel or slick manner to supervisor, demonstrating clear understanding of project tasks. *Major idea came from student, or student significantly extended the proposed subject.	Student solved detailed technical problems independently but relied on supervisor for higher level issues.	Student developed the project independently but used supervisor to solve problems.	Student left problems unsolved, resulting in poor performance. Student either did not seek or act on supervisor's suggestions sufficiently or extensively relied on supervisor to solve problems.	No contact with supervisor or ignored supervisor's suggestions- despite obvious problems.	

Structure, Clarity, and Presentation (Weight 10%)

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Overall lucidity and information density	High density – every sentence adds value and aids understanding. Demonstrates “ownership” of subject.*			Clear and easy to understand. Some repetitions. Areas where additional description is required			Mostly clear, but somewhat verbose and repetitive			Very little information – fails to explain work except in the most general terms. Information poorly organised.			Scale of Project so small that little to discuss. Or inability to explain project content						
Analytical skills/discussion	Critical skills applied in depth* to every area of document – from survey of existing work to results achieved			Reasoned argument. This could be in areas of own work, or applied to pre-existing or future work			Lacks criticism, or comments relatively obvious in nature. Reference to other sources mostly qualitative			No critical skills applied – just descriptive. Discussion limited to restating results. Few references to other work			Scale of project so small that little to discuss. No sources used, no evaluation. Poor description						
English – style, grammar, spelling	Literate, appropriate to content *Enjoyable to read			Minor difficulties with English grammar			Frequent problems with grammar or reliance on automated spell-check			Some incoherent sentences implying difficulty in articulating. Frequent errors			Inability to create sentences - points rather than phrases						
Boiler plate – Format and labelling for References, Contents and Appendices	Everything present, numbered & formatted for easy navigation. Referencing is of a high standard. Key sections found instantly*			Some minor problems but structure otherwise professional. Items cited or directly quoted are correctly referenced.			Level of problems indicate rushed or sloppy work, though most of structure attempted. Referencing is limited.			Many aspects missing, or document very short. Referencing inadequate though attempted			No attempt at presentation. Most aspects missing.						

Report Chapters – Coverage and Coherence (Weight 50%)

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Chapter 1: Introduction Scene setting for project. Aims and Objectives	Right level of review for general reader, giving good overview of material to come. Well justified explanation of the problem being solved with supporting evidence. Aims and Objectives are clear and well defined. *Generates enthusiasm and anticipation in the reader			Reasonably good coverage, but missing some details. An explanation of the problem to be solved is given with limited evidence. Aims and Objectives are clearly stated.			Basic explanation for the overall direction for the project. Aims and objectives are stated, but are overly focussed on individual tasks to perform or features to implement, rather than overall project goals			Difficult to understand direction of the project. Aims and objectives unclear. Significant mismatch with project content.			Major mismatch between introduction and project.			
Chapter 2: Context Wider Context literature Survey Current solutions Primary research	Detailed in-depth review of relevant literature. Includes some in-depth primary research or case studies. Includes a detailed review of existing techniques or solutions Fully places the project in the wider context. *Literature survey reveals new or surprising information.			Good review of literature, but comments or criticisms not sufficiently analytical. Includes some relevant primary research or case studies. Includes a review of existing techniques or solutions.			Limited literature Review. Limited review of existing techniques or solutions.			Some background information provided but relies too heavily on informal sources. Has no analytical discussion.			Does not provide the context required for this project.			
Chapter3: New Ideas Overall design of new ideas or research	Design clearly in line with the project Aims. Clear counterpoint to Ch2, justifying idea and explaining its basis as well as content. Details of product functionality along with suitable diagrams. Demonstration is highly professional, fully			Design well defined and has some new ideas and extensions of existing solutions. Limited attempt to set fully in context or justify as a reasonable solution. Basic functionality described. Demonstration is well-prepared and functional, showing main features effectively. Student provides clear explanation linking the demo to design objectives.			Design limited to the development of an existing or well-founded idea. Described but not justified. Limited details of functionality. Demonstration covers only partial functionality or unclear novelty. Explanation limited or lacks linkage between demo and design rationale.			No novelty offered. Description of product unimpressive and fairly obvious. Not clear what functionality has been produced. Demo is incomplete, or fails to demonstrate the key aspects of design. Limited			No solutions offered – implementation /investigation inadequately specified. No working demo or failure to show or explain any functional design element. Demonstration does not support the project’s stated aims.			

	functional, and convincingly communicates novelty and purpose. The student confidently explains design choices and results.			ability to discuss or defend design decisions.		
	*Idea with true novelty					
Chapter 4: Implementation [Relevant where the project involves the implementation of software or hardware]	Implementation choices are well documented with a relevant level of detail. Sufficient for reader to understand structure and reproduce without being verbose. Demonstration is professional, showing complete, robust, and efficient functionality. The demo strongly reinforces design and implementation quality, and the student confidently explains technical decisions. Clear impression of process followed. *Elegant design/novel implementation	Good description of implementation choices Some detail missed or others over-elaborated. A development methodology seems to have been followed. Demonstration effectively shows the system working with most key features functional. Student clearly explains main components and implementation process.	Implementation choices described in outline. Does not give a clear impression of a development methodology being followed. Demo shows limited or partial functionality; explanation lacks depth or clarity about implementation steps.	Limited description of implementation choices. Reads like a diary of software generated rather than design. Basic or incomplete demo showing minimal working functionality; unclear linkage to described implementation.	No description of design and implementation choices. Unconnected with the rest of the report. No functioning demo, or demonstration unrelated to project implementation. Unable to explain development process.	
Chapter 4: Investigation [Relevant when the project requires an investigation]	A properly conducted investigation based on scientific principles and demonstrates the use of tools, techniques and standards for an investigation in this area to a high standard. Demonstration clearly and professionally presents findings or investigative methods (e.g., simulations, data visualisations, models). Student confidently explains process, results, and significance of findings. *Develops novel investigation techniques	A properly constructed investigation based on scientific principles that demonstrates the use of tools, techniques and standards for an investigation in this area. Demonstration effectively supports the investigation by showing data collection or analysis steps. Student provides clear commentary linking demo outcomes to research aims.	A reasonably constructed investigation that may have flaws but does provide useful data for evaluation. Demonstration shows partial or limited evidence of investigation results; explanation lacks clarity or connection to the investigative approach.	An investigation that has substantial flaws and provides only a limited amount of useful data for evaluation. Demonstration weakly represents the investigative process or outputs; incomplete or unclear explanation of results.	A poorly constructed investigation that fails to yield useful results. No meaningful demonstration of the investigation; unable to explain data, findings, or process effectively.	

Chapter 5: Results and evaluation	Excellent testing plan used to evaluate the project. Clear experimental method. Results detailed where necessary but overview when appropriate. Rational discussion of good and bad results. Results should include clear quantitative analysis such as numerical performance data, statistical comparisons, or measurable system metrics. Demonstration clearly evidences all test outcomes and evaluation results. Student explains performance, limitations, and reliability with confidence and precision. *Surprising Insights.	Good testing plan used to evaluate the project. Good method and description of experiments. Discussion may be less analytical, more descriptive. <i>Includes quantitative data (e.g., timings, accuracy rates, efficiency values) supported by qualitative discussion where relevant.</i> Demo effectively shows results in action and supports the evaluation. Student can explain test outcomes and performance metrics.	Testing plan not clear though some relevant experiments have been performed. Results described but not explained adequately. <i>Some basic quantitative evidence expected, though it may be incomplete or weakly linked to evaluation findings.</i> Demo shows partial or limited results; lacks clear connection between what is demonstrated and evaluation findings.	Experiments appear fairly arbitrary and limited. Quantitative results only with limited structure/method. Minimal discussion. Limited or unclear quantitative testing; results mainly descriptive without measurable data. Demo loosely reflects results but lacks clarity, completeness, or meaningful interpretation during presentation.	Some discussion of potential experiments, but no evidence of having actually carried any out. <i>No quantitative or measurable evidence presented; evaluation remains purely descriptive or speculative.</i> No demonstrable results or testing shown; unable to justify outcomes or performance through demonstration.	
Chapter 6: Conclusions Own critique and future work discussion of LESPIs, reflection in relation to employment aspirations.	Sets own work in context of aims and prior work in field. Shows good understanding of what is best course of future action. In-depth insights into LESPIs. Comments on success backed up by reference to results. In depth reflections	Reasonably analytical summary of work, though maybe not fully contextualised. Future work plan reasonable though not properly justified. Good discussion of LESPIs. Clear reflections on skills developed during work on course and project in relation to employability aspirations. Demo outcomes are well-	Summarises work without evaluating its worth. Future plans may lack sense of priorities. LESPIs discussion limited. Some reflections of employability aspirations with limited depth. Demo is mentioned briefly but not clearly linked to conclusions or lessons learned.	Purely descriptive. Comments are unsubstantiated. Future plans trivial. LESPIs discussion trivial. Limited reflective comments on career aspirations in relation to the project. Demo	Conclusions incompatible with project itself. Future plans impractical. Lack of understanding of LESPIs. No reflective comments. No demo or no reference to demo outcomes; fails to connect any	

	on skills developed during work on course and project in relation to employability aspirations. Demonstration effectively reinforces conclusions — student clearly links demo outcomes to achieved goals, lessons learned, and future improvements. Demonstration used confidently as evidence of reflection and critical understanding. *Surprising Insights	referenced in conclusions; student discusses what worked well and areas for improvement based on demonstration.	Limited analysis of results seen during the demo.	not effectively connected to reflection; weak explanation of what was learned or what could be improved.	demonstration evidence to conclusions or reflection.	
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